decide upon. The Chinese side also claimed that Pakistan had reliably assured them that the JeM was defunct, and that Masood Azhar had 'retired'. [7] The Chinese expected India to believe that they were actively engaged in making a serious effort to bridge the gap between India and Pakistan. This last claim about Masood Azhar's 'retirement' was simply absurd. It showed how uncaring the Chinese could be about the sensitivities of other countries. Although the Chinese are consummate diplomats, there have been instances when over-confidence in their comprehensive national power and global influence led them to adopt positions that goad the aggrieved opposite party into action. This was the case in this instance.

The External Affairs Minister of India explicitly conveyed to her counterpart that this was not an India–Pakistan matter but one entirely between India and China, and that India regarded it as important for China to re-visit the 'hold' and to engage with India in the UN to move forward on the listing. The matter was pressed again by India at two summit interactions—the G20 Summit in Beijing and the BRICS summit in Goa—in September–October 2016. The Chinese realized that their strategy of procedural delays and vaguely worded assurances had not succeeded, and, therefore, it 'blocked' the listing for a second time on 29 December 2016. In 2017, a third attempt was made to list Masood Azhar.

This time the sponsors were the United States, Britain and France. It met the same fate. China first placed a hold and then blocked the listing in November 2017. But, at least, the two attempts in 2016 and in 2017 had demonstrated that China had been unsuccessful in convincing other members of the 1267 Sanctions Committee that this was a purely India–Pakistan problem, or in convincing India that this was not an India–China issue. And it had the added advantage of flushing China out into the open as the only hold-out.